



THE PAIN OF WATCHING NON GEEKS USE A COMPUTER...

A must see comic for any geek
<http://bit.ly/9GzlBw>

ALL PIRATES ABOARD THE IPAD!

With the new VLC player app now available for the iPad, you can play all your media content on it. It can be anything from an AVI to an MKV file format, giving you the freedom to watch all your downloaded stuff, yes even the illegal ones. The iPad supported the Quicktime format (.MOV) till now, until the VLC app came into the picture rescuing all the .XVID and .DVIX files.

<http://bit.ly/byDxAh>

**TWITTER IS ONLY FOR NEWS AND
CONTENT PLEASE...**

Kevin Thau, VP business and corporate development for Twitter has acknowledged that the micro blogging site should not be considered as a social networking place. Rather its meant for breaking news and other useful content posted through tweets. Point taken, but then what about all the idiotic minute to minute nonsense?

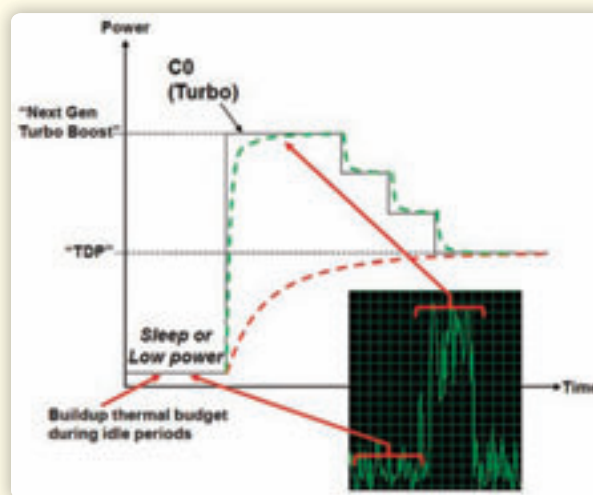
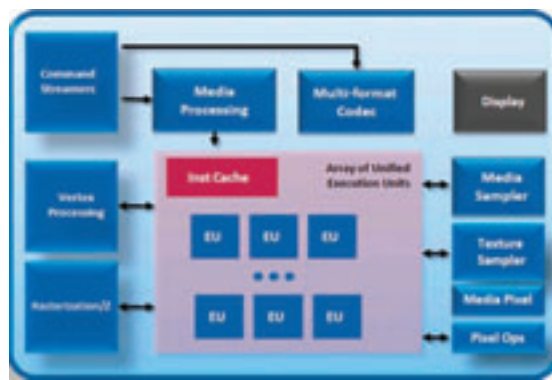
<http://rww.to/bxx9bi>

The majority of Intel's changes come from the philosophy that anything that could be done as a more efficient fixed function would be. So at every point in the 3D pipe where a fixed function is assumed, there is an explicit fixed function—this improves throughput per watt, reduces latency, reduces complexity in the driver programming model, and “lets the shaders do shaders” (in Intel speak). Intel says it has found the optimal balance of fixed function to compute within the GPU.

Everything being on the same chip has made it possible to dynamically shift power around as it's required—and that benefits the graphics as well. (This helps deal with the problem of some programs swallowing up CPU cycles, and others pegging the graphics.)

The GPU is constructed of the same 32nm process as the CPU cores themselves, which gives it a performance boost right away. It's also got its own power and clock planes: It can be powered down or clocked up independently of the GPU depending on the demands of the workload, and it can Turbo Boost on its own as well. Perhaps most importantly, the video has equal access to the LLC, and it's all controlled by the video driver. (One Intel rep said that putting the video system behind the LLC was the single biggest change in Sandy Bridge.) This reduces the number of trips to the main system memory, which put greater demands on both power and performance.

The programmable shader hardware (shaders, cores, and execution units) are composed of execution units (EUs). They contain larger register files for increased parallelism and efficient complex shader execution, a second generation parallel branch for efficient parallelization in the face of deeply nested conditionals, and new instructions to reach 1-to-1 with API



tion of Intel HD Graphics—four to 20 times as much, by Intel's reckoning. Also, whereas previous graphics architectures repartitioned the register file as needed to make the most out of smaller numbers of registers, Sandy Bridge's GPU has a fixed 120 registers per thread. Intel estimates that with all of these changes, each shader unit will be able to deliver double the throughput of those currently used.

Driver overload has been reduced as well. All orthogonal states, re-jit, and shader management have been removed by the use of fixed functions. This all has the side benefit of freeing up CPU load to redirect power to the graphics.

Two versions of Sandy Bridge's graphics will be available when the hardware launches next year: one with 12 EUs (for all laptops and high-performance desktops), and one with 6 EUs (for lower-end models).

Sandy Bridge graphics will support OpenGL 3.1 and DirectX 10.1 – not DX11.

Future-focused media processing

In separate recognition of how important media consumption has become, even to (or perhaps especially to) those in the mainstream